

Legal Claims List

Cymbal Voyages Brand Studio · Agency onboarding packet · Last updated September 2026

This document governs every piece of customer-facing copy: email, paid social, paid search, site and app, confirmations and anything we hand to an affiliate partner. It is a hard block, not a style preference. The Brand Studio agent must check drafts against it before a brief or creative is presented for review, and legal reviews every asset before it goes live. Where this document and the voice guide differ, this document wins.

Banned phrases

The phrases in the left column may not appear in customer-facing copy in any form, including as hashtags, in image text, or as paraphrases that carry the same claim ("lowest price, period" is the same claim as "guaranteed lowest price"). Internal media terms such as "always-on" for a continuous program are fine in briefs and are not customer-facing.

Banned phrase	Why	Say this instead
guaranteed lowest price	An unverifiable price claim; we do not price-match.	"From \$X per person, taxes and fees included."
best in the world	Unverifiable superlative.	A specific, checkable detail about the place.
risk-free	Misstates cancellation terms, which vary by booking.	The actual cancellation terms, stated plainly ("free cancellation until 14 days before departure").
#1 (in any construction)	Unsubstantiated ranking.	Nothing. Cut the ranking and keep the fact.
cheapest	Comparative price claim.	"From \$X per person" or "our lowest fare this season on this route," with substantiation.
always	An absolute that any exception makes false.	The specific timeframe or condition.
world-class	Unverifiable quality claim.	What the place offers, concretely.
unforgettable, breathtaking, paradise	Puffery inconsistent with the voice; "paradise" also collides with a real place name we should not appear to be describing.	Describe what the reader will see or do.
hidden gem, bucket list, once-in-a-lifetime	Category clichés; "once-in-a-lifetime" also implies a scarcity we cannot substantiate.	The name of the place and one reason to go.
last chance, don't miss out, hurry	Urgency claims that our history shows damage member trust.	The real deadline, stated once ("book by October 31").
free (unqualified)	A "free night" or "free cancellation" must carry its conditions.	"Free night on four-night stays, February departures, while inventory lasts."

Required disclaimers

Prices. Every asset that shows a price, including "from" prices, carries this line, verbatim or with the bracketed terms filled in: "Per person, based on double occupancy, taxes and fees included unless stated; availability limited." If a price excludes taxes or fees for any reason, the exclusion must be stated next to the price, not in a footnote. Prices must be current at the time the asset goes live and must be pulled from the booking system, not from a brief.

Loyalty points. Every asset that mentions Cymbal Compass points, bonus points, double

points or tier benefits carries: "Cymbal Compass points are subject to program terms. Points expire after 24 months with no account activity. Bonus points post within 14 days of completed travel." Where space permits, add "10,000 points is worth \$100 toward a booking." Bonus points may not be described as cash, and the dollar value of points is stated as "worth \$X toward a booking," never as "\$X back."

Offers. Any offer (percent off, free night, bonus points) must state the eligible bookings, the booking window, the travel window and how the offer is applied, on the landing page and in the email footer at minimum.

Superlatives and comparisons

We do not use superlatives about ourselves, our prices or our destinations. "Best," "top," "lowest," "biggest" and their equivalents are out unless they are tied to a dated, sourced fact ("our lowest fare on this route since January 2026," with the source on file). We do not name competitors in customer-facing copy, do not compare prices to any other seller, and do not use constructions that imply a comparison ("unlike other sites"). A third-party award or rating may be cited only with the awarding body's name, the year and their written permission.

Imagery claims

A photograph presented alongside a named property or destination must show that property or destination. Stock imagery may be used only for generic category placements and may not be captioned as a specific place. Room, view and beach photographs must match the room category being sold. Weather statements must be accurate for the month advertised ("82 degrees in March" needs a source). People shown in advertising must be models or customers with a signed release; no real customer is identifiable without written consent. Imagery may not depict a destination outside the travel window being sold (no hurricane-season beach shots labeled "September" without a note on the season).

Sign-off checklist

Before an asset is presented for legal review, confirm each of the following:

1. No banned phrase or paraphrase appears in copy, image text, subject line, alt text or hashtag.
2. The price disclaimer is present wherever a price appears, and prices were pulled from the booking system on the date noted.
3. The loyalty points disclaimer is present wherever points are mentioned, with the 24-month expiry and the 14-day posting rule.
4. Offer conditions (eligible bookings, booking window, travel window, application) appear on the landing page and in the email footer.
5. Every image is licensed for the channels and dates of use, shows the place it is captioned as, and any identifiable person has a release on file.
6. No competitor is named or implied, and no comparative or superlative claim appears without a dated source.

Legal records the reviewer's name and the date in the brief's Legal review notes section. An asset without a recorded sign-off does not go live.